▶ ANDHRA PRADESH

Top Cops Caught in Crossfire

Two years on, senior IPS officers remain sidelined as politics and policing collide in Andhra Pradesh

By **Prasad Nichenametla**

WHAT GOES AROUND COMES AROUND. It's a lesson several senior police officers in Andhra Pradesh have learned, much to their discomfiture. Nearly two years have passed since the change of guard in the state, and eight IPS officers still find themselves off the 'active duty' list—five under prolonged suspension (including two of DGP rank), while three still await posting.

Weeks after the Chandrababu Naidu-led Telugu Desam Party (TDP) took charge in mid-2024, 23 officers were placed on the 'waiting for posting' list, while the new government reviewed their controversial roles during the previous YSR Congress regime. Some of them were allotted work at some point. As for the others, TDP insiders frame the actions as a 'correction' for their alleged excesses. The Opposition YSRCP, though, says the government is being vindictive, and accuses it of demoralising the All India Services corps.

MULTIPLE ALLEGATIONS

The Naidu government has turned the screws on some of the top officers, slapping a number of cases against them.

By **Jumana Shah**

▶ GUJARAT

THE BIG FAT GUJJU WEDDING ZONE

Gujarat wants a slice of the 'destination wedding' pie. Raising a toast, though, might be a problem



GUJARAT HAS WORLD-FACING BOARDROOMS, sleek highways, lion safaris and pilgrimage circuits. And it makes cracking good food—er, at least of one genre. Now, it also has a new government initiative, 'Wed in Gujarat', ostensibly to tap into the destination wedding boom, but also to slow the trend of locals preferring "outbound *shaadis*".

The idea to try and create a sense of the exotic that can appeal to the famously world-trotting Gujarati mind as well as to those from outside, says tourism secretary Kuldeep Arya. "This is a niche tourism sector for us. Weddings are currently not so popular in Gujarat. The trend even for locals is to have their destination weddings outside the state, which we would like to reverse. Besides, elaborate wedding events add a lot to the local economy."

Widely welcomed by all stakeholders, the idea nevertheless faces a rather large hurdle in the state's old policy of alcohol prohibition. The announcement has also reignited debate over missed opportunities and the unsustainable scaling of infrastructure driven by policy constraints—issues that are likely to shape the prospects of Gujarat's wedding ecosystem.

The revenues are nothing to sniff at. Almost 30 per cent of all Indian nuptials are now destination weddings. According to